

SUNNYSIDE COMMUNITY ASSOCIATION
MONTHLY BOARD MEETING
Tuesday, May 5, 2026
7:00-8:00 pm

Location: Zoom

Board Members Present:

Rainer Otto, Mark Groskreutz, Renee Groskreutz, Valeri Cardello, RJ Cardello, Mark Stellner, Alyssa Stellner, Mike Sarullo, Rosa Koretzky

Quorum was established and meeting was called to order at 7:00 pm by HOA President Rainer Otto.

Meeting Overview:

The HOA board meeting focused on officer elections and planning upcoming social events. The board elected Rainer as president, Mark as vice president, RJ as treasurer, and approved co-secretaries with Val and Renee serving in that role. The group discussed organizing various social activities including a trick-or-treat event, popsicle social, and potential end-of-summer barbecue. They reviewed the Sunnyside entrance upgrade project which received an ~\$8,000 estimate for sprinkler system repair and planting. Val provided updates on safety improvements, noting tickets have been submitted to install speed limit signs and reflective bumps at the entrance. The board also discussed creating a new website to better organize HOA documentation and considered moving their Dropbox files to a more permanent solution. Financial updates showed 34 out of 52 checks had been received, with 18 still outstanding.

Action Items:

Rainer – Board President

- Ask the landscape installer to break out the entrance upgrade bid into detailed components and get at least one more bid for the sprinkler repair and planting work.
- Research what it would take (cost, materials, labor) to plant ~10 feet of the entrance area and report back at the next meeting.
- Update meeting slides with detailed safety updates and outcomes (from Val's notes) and circulate to the group for review.
- Schedule next HOA board meeting for June 16th (adjusted to June 23rd via email)

RJ - Treasurer

- Discuss approach to completing irrigation upgrades.

Val - Secretary

- Resend the email about fire department pool water access placards to interested board members.
- Send March and April board meeting minutes to Rainer and the group for review and finalization.

Renee – Social Chair/Co-Secretary

- Update the book club meeting date for May to the 29th and work with Val to notify members.
- Prepare monthly minutes for May meeting leveraging AI note taker.

Mike – HOA Webmaster

- Research website platforms, costs, and options (including privacy controls), and report back to the group with a proposal.
- Check how much free space is available on Google Drive for the HOA Gmail account and evaluate feasibility of migrating files from Dropbox to Google Drive.
- Coordinate with Val to access the current Dropbox, assess files, and plan migration to a new HOA-controlled account (or Google Drive) as appropriate.

Alyssa – Board member at large

- Follow-up with city contact (Jennifer Grieko or relevant admin) regarding Sol Vista field maintenance and report back to the group.

Collaboration – All Board Members

- All residents (encouraged): Submit individual maintenance tickets to the City of RPV requesting weed cutting/removal for the empty field at Sol Vista/Sunnyside Ridge Road intersection.
- Board: Plan and coordinate a neighborhood social events for summer fun, including logistics, hosting, and communications.

Detailed Discussion:

1. Board Elections

The meeting focused on electing officers for the organization. Rainer agreed to continue as president, Mark G. as vice president, RJ as treasurer, and Renee and Val as co-secretaries. Mike expressed interest in taking on the webmaster role, though this was left as a discussion item for next meeting. Mark S. and Alyssa indicated they would serve as members at large for now due to their busy schedules, though they expressed interest in taking on positions in the future. Rosa also indicated she would serve as member at large.

2. Secretary Update

Val and Rainer reviewed the annual meeting minutes and presentation. Draft annual meeting minutes and presentation will be emailed but not finalized until next annual meeting. Val presented previous monthly board meeting minutes (March and April) and motioned for approval. These minutes were approved and will be shared with the neighborhood.

3. Treasurer Update

Treasurer RJ Cardello reported \$8,969 in the HOA bank account and noted 100% dues collection from the previous year, with proposed budget items including sprinkler system repair and new plantings. RJ reported that 34 checks had been received this year, with 18 still outstanding, noting that collecting payments from renters tends to be more challenging. The group also discussed a high water bill of \$480, deciding to accept a credit on their account rather than requesting a refund check to simplify the process.

4. Neighborhood Entrance Upgrade Budget Discussion

Entrance Upgrade Estimate

Rainer presented an ~\$8,000 quote for the Sunnyside entrance upgrade and maintenance, which exceeded the budget, leading to a discussion about seeking additional funding through Rancho Palos Verdes' beautification budget. The group agreed that more bids were needed for the entrance project, with Mark emphasizing the importance of obtaining three bids for accurate cost estimation.

Landscaping and Sprinkler System Plans

The group discussed plans for landscaping work, with Rainer proposing to start with planting 10 feet of area starting at the bus stop as a test. RJ offered to handle the sprinkler system work himself, noting he had already identified issues with the system after receiving

an erroneous \$500 water bill. The team reviewed the total estimate of \$7,975, which includes \$2,275 for plants and materials and \$5,500 for labor, and a disposal fee.

5. Road Safety Improvements and City Requests for Sol Vista Field Maintenance

Val reported on three safety-related items:

- Parking near the entrance of the neighborhood
- Speed
- Tight turning Radius at entrance

The HOA will request speed limit signs and additional reflective bumps from the city to improve safety at the street entrance. Val submitted tickets to the city regarding street marking improvements, which were listed as two separate work items.

Alyssa inquired about addressing the Sol Vista field maintenance issue. Val noted that previous tickets submitted over the past two years had mixed results, with the city previously allowing goats for maintenance but now declining due to cost and policy changes. The group discussed submitting tickets to the city regarding maintenance issues, with Val explaining that while more tickets can be helpful, the city's response timing has been inconsistent. Val offered to copy Jennifer Greico, on the new ticket.

6. Community Safety Measures Discussion

The meeting covered several topics including fire safety measures for pool owners, coyote sightings, and wildlife encounters. Val shared information about obtaining fire department placards for pool water access and had previously notified local pool owners about this option. The group also discussed recent rattlesnake sightings, including a baby rattlesnake spotted in a resident's yard, and agreed to include information about rattlesnake safety tips from the city in the annual meeting presentation.

The conversation also addressed concerns about the water reservoir at the corner of PVE and PVN that appeared empty, with Renee clarifying that it was designed as a bladder-style reservoir to prevent contamination and evaporation. Alyssa had initially raised concerns about the reservoir's status during fires, and Renee recommended that Cal Water manages the reservoir and can address these questions.

7. HOA Website Revival Discussion

The group discussed reviving the HOA website, which was previously closed due to cost and privacy concerns. Mike offered to research new website creation options, noting that hosting costs have significantly decreased since the previous \$42 six-month fee. The group agreed that Mike would investigate current platforms and costs, with the goal of providing a

central location for HOA documents and information that would be easier to access than the current email-based system. Val mentioned considerations about transitioning from their current Dropbox, which is owned by a former resident, and suggested finding a virtual home for the physical documents currently stored in Cardello garage.

The group discussed moving from Dropbox to a web-based platform for better privacy and accessibility. They agreed to explore options like Google Drive under the HOA's Gmail account as an alternative.

8. Social Events Brainstorm

The Board discussed planning upcoming social events, with particular attention to accommodating the changing demographics of the neighborhood. The group discussed organizing a trick-or-treat event for Halloween and explored ideas for bridging the gap between young and older residents, with Alyssa mentioning a potential program involving book reading pairs. The team also considered mailbox decorations. The Board also discussed family name address sign but ultimately decided against including personal information due to privacy concerns.

The group discussed neighborhood holiday decorations and a potential popsicle/ice cream social event for later in the summer, with Renee noting success in scheduling the previous ice cream social on the Sunday before school starts.

9. Next Sunnyside Association Activities Planned

The board discussed upcoming social events and meeting schedules. They decided to reschedule the book club to May 29th and Dogs and Donuts to May 30th due to Renee's availability.

They agreed to hold the next board meeting on June 16th (later changed to June 23rd via email) at 7 pm.

Meeting was adjourned at 8:00 pm.